BEHIND THE BUILD · PROJECT MANAGEMENT · 8 OF 8

QA Dashboard

AI Literacy for the Modern Workforce

Quality assurance on this project followed Hardman's "AI Evals" method for L&D. When the practitioner's core job shifts from authoring content to evaluating AI-generated content, Hardman names two critical skills: specification, which defines "good" precisely enough for AI to produce it, and verification, which reliably detects when output fails that bar[1]. The method is a binary pass/fail cycle: select an output type, collect samples, define checks, score, diagnose root cause (specification failure vs. generalization failure), revise the specification, re-score, and repeat on a schedule[2].

Applied across four output categories and six data files, it ran as ten structured verification passes, a triple-validation protocol for the data files, and an eight-check capability framework, all recorded below. Everything the passes surfaced was resolved before or during the build.

TEN VERIFICATION PASSES

QA pass	Scope · sample	Result
Capability check logs (M1–M4) Inline pass/fail checks during authoring	Narrative, scenario stems, feedback, KC items `4 modules`	All passed; outstanding items resolved before build handoff.
Knowledge-check evaluation Binary checks: scenario-based, application-level, plausible distractors, consequence feedback, no cueing	16 KC items across 4 modules `16 items`	KC-1.1–1.3 revised for distractor balance; KC-2.3/2.4 for forward-reference; KC-4.4 Option C for length parity.
Practice-activity traceability audit Each P-activity vs. action-map and content D-codes	12 practice activities (P1–P12) `12 items`	All 12 match across both sources in behavior targets and descriptions.
KC–objective traceability Each KC stem vs. its referenced performance objective	16 KCs against 17 objectives `16 items`	All 16 correctly assess their referenced objectives.
Data-file triple validation Schema, value verification vs. sources, cross-file consistency	6 JSON files `6 files × 3 passes`	All validated; $55 → $54 and citation page-range corrections applied.
Cross-cutting integration check (1) Event model, state shape, completion logic, consumer mapping	5 component specs + 6 data files `28 edits across 6 files`	95 event keys cataloged; 37+ state keys reconciled; master event-key table produced.
Cross-cutting integration check (2) Content flow, terminology, tone, D-code trace, color batch fix	4 content docs + 2 planning + 4 specs `6 tasks`	All clean; six 03a alignment-matrix discrepancies corrected; two stale markers flagged.
JSX artifact audit Reconcile interactive diagrams vs. the built codebase	2 JSX files against src/ `18 discrepancies`	5 major, 13 minor found and resolved; downstream doc fixes applied.

QA pass	Scope · sample	Result
Citation verification pass Every inline statistic vs. reference-quotes.md and source papers	21 statistics across 4 modules `21 items`	One known discrepancy (81% vs 84% median savings) confirmed resolved per the Figure 6 methodology.
Reference item (R1–R7) design review PDF assets vs. design system; content accuracy and register	7 reference items at 10 placements `7 items`	All 7 redesigned in the project design system; contextual placement verified.

TRIPLE-VALIDATION DATA PROTOCOL

Each of the six JSON data files went through three dedicated validation passes, a stricter standard than a single-pass eval, because learners draw conclusions directly from the dashboards this data powers.

1 Schema validation

Field names, data types, required vs. optional fields, and structural consistency across array entries.

2 Value verification

Every numeric value and quoted string traced to a specific page, table, or figure in the source paper, cross-checked against reference-quotes.md.

3 Cross-file consistency

Values shared across files (e.g., the 81% median-savings figure) verified for consistency; each file's consuming components confirmed against the specs.

Data file	Source	Key content	Status
augmentation-automation.json	Handa et al.[3]	Occupation/task breakdowns; 57%/43% augmentation-automation split	● Pass
productivity-gains.json	Tamkin & McCrory[4]	Task time reductions; 81% median savings (Fig. 6 caption, p. 13)	● Pass · 2 corrections
geographic-adoption.json	Appel, McCrory & Tamkin[5]	Country-level usage rates; institutional-inertia indicators	● Pass
wef-skill-demand.json	WEF Future of Jobs 2025[6]	Fastest-growing/declining skills; employer transformation expectations	● Pass
interviewer-findings.json	Anthropic Interviewer[7]	86% time savings; 65% satisfaction; 69% stigma; 48% career transition	● Pass
adoption-trends.json	Multiple sources	Longitudinal adoption rates; interaction-mode temporal data	● Pass

EIGHT-CHECK CAPABILITY FRAMEWORK

Each check is Capability (does the output do what it should?) or Risk (what can go wrong that the learner cannot detect?). Risk checks matter most in learning contexts, because learners consume content without an answer key.

Scenario authenticity CAPABILITY

Does the stem present a recognizable workplace situation with a job title, context, and decision point?

Application-level cognitive demand CAPABILITY

Does the item test applying a concept to a novel situation rather than recalling a definition?

Distractor plausibility RISK

Are all non-preferred options actions a reasonable professional might consider? (No trick or absurd choices.)

Correct-answer cueing absence RISK

Is the preferred option free of length, specificity, or hedging cues that distinguish it without content knowledge?

Consequence-based feedback CAPABILITY

Does each option branch lead to a realistic observed outcome rather than a "Correct" / "Try again" label?

Source fidelity RISK

Does every cited statistic match its source paper (checked against reference-quotes.md)?

Register consistency CAPABILITY

Does the text hold the "knowledgeable peer" second-person register without slipping into lecture or compliance tone?

Forward-reference avoidance RISK

Does the item avoid requiring knowledge from a module the learner has not yet completed?

The single-evaluator limit

The structured passes above were run by the same person who authored the content, so specification failures are hardest to detect where the specifier and the evaluator share a mental model. An independent review of both the code and the content by a different model, Claude Fable, provided a second pass that did not share that mental model and surfaced issues that were then fixed. The same conflict was named in the capstone pilot, where the instructor was also the researcher[8]. Its controls included success criteria fixed in advance, critical feedback kept in the analysis, anonymous labeling of responses, and triangulation across four data sources[9]. The pass/fail checks above carry the first two forward. The independent model review stands in for the third, though it does not replace what an organizational deployment should add: an evaluation role separate from authoring, with inter-rater reliability established for the check framework. Still, the work had more than one reviewer, and the binary pass/fail format is designed to transfer: its checks are specific enough that a different evaluator would reach substantially similar conclusions. That transferability is the practical test of whether the methodology scales beyond one person.

Notes

1. Philippa Hardman, "'AI Evals' for L&D: How to Check Whether Your AI-Generated Content Is Good Enough to Ship," Substack, April 2026, section "The Two Skills That Define the Shift", https://drphilippahardman.substack.com/p/ai-evals-for-l-and-d-how-to-check
2. Philippa Hardman, "'AI Evals' for L&D: How to Check Whether Your AI-Generated Content Is Good Enough to Ship," Substack, April 2026, sections "Step 1" to "Step 10", https://drphilippahardman.substack.com/p/ai-evals-for-l-and-d-how-to-check
3. Kunal Handa et al., "Which Economic Tasks are Performed with AI? Evidence from Millions of Claude Conversations," Anthropic, February 2025, https://arxiv.org/abs/2503.04761
4. Alex Tamkin and Peter McCrory, "Estimating AI Productivity Gains from Claude Conversations," Anthropic, November 2025, https://www.anthropic.com/research/estimating-productivity-gains

5. Ruth Appel, Peter McCrory, Alex Tamkin, et al., “The Anthropic Economic Index Report: Uneven Geographic and Enterprise AI Adoption,” Anthropic, September 2025, https://www.anthropic.com/research/anthropic-economic-index-september-2025-report
6. World Economic Forum, “The Future of Jobs Report 2025,” January 2025, https://reports.weforum.org/docs/WEF_Future_of_Jobs_Report_2025.pdf
7. Kunal Handa et al., “Introducing Anthropic Interviewer: What 1,250 Professionals Told Us About Working with AI,” Anthropic, December 2025, https://www.anthropic.com/research/anthropic-interviewer
8. Michael Ritchot, “Token-Level Abstraction in Large Language Models: A Design-Based Inquiry into AI Comprehension Pathways,” master’s capstone, Western Governors University, June 2025, p. 39, https://ritchot.me/docs/capstone.pdf
9. Michael Ritchot, “Token-Level Abstraction in Large Language Models: A Design-Based Inquiry into AI Comprehension Pathways,” master’s capstone, Western Governors University, June 2025, pp. 39–40, https://ritchot.me/docs/capstone.pdf

© Michael Ritchot. Code licensed under the MIT License. Instructional content licensed under CC BY-NC-SA 4.0.